TITLE 4 THEME 2 CHILD EDITION

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THE BIG SURPRISE

30 Times God Showed Up in the Old Testament to Point to Jesus

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A Note for Parents

Do you like surprises? A surprise birthday party. A surprise gift. A surprise visit from a friend. Surprises are fun. They make us smile. They make us gasp. They make us say, "Wow!"

The Old Testament is full of surprises. God shows up in ways nobody expects. He shows up in a bush. In a fire. In a whisper. In a baby. In a star. In a donkey. In a storm. Every time, it is a surprise. And every surprise points to one person. Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. Each day is a surprise. You will open the surprise. You will see what is inside. And you will find that it points to Jesus. Get ready to gasp. Get ready to smile. Get ready for the Big Surprise.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret surprise. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture or do the coloring prompt. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Surprise in the Garden

The Secret Surprise

"Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the LORD God as he was walking in the garden in the cool of the day." - Genesis 3:8

Surprise! God was walking in a garden. In the cool of the day. Adam and Eve heard His footsteps. They hid. But He was there. He was walking. He was looking. He was close. That is the first surprise. God came near.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The surprise in the garden was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is God walking with us. He came near. He came close. He is the Big Surprise. He was in the garden. He is with us now.

Family Activity

Go for a family walk today. As you walk, take turns saying, "Surprise! God is walking with me." Talk about how God walked with Adam and Eve. Talk about how He walks with us. He is full of surprises.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for walking with me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A garden with a path, footprints, and a big surprise face.

Day 02: The Surprise in the Tent

The Secret Surprise

"Abraham looked up and saw three men standing nearby. When he saw them, he hurried from the entrance of his tent to meet them and bowed low to the ground." - Genesis 18:2

Surprise! Three visitors came to Abraham's tent. One of them was God. Abraham made them dinner. God ate at his table. God talked with him. God stayed. That is a surprise. God at a table.

The Big Reveal

"Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with that person." - Revelation 3:20

The surprise in the tent was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus wants to sit at your table. He wants to eat with you. He is the Big Surprise. He wants to be with you.

Family Activity

Set the table for a special family dinner. Add one extra plate. Pretend Jesus is sitting with you. Talk about how He wants to be with us. Let each person say one thing they want to tell Jesus.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for wanting to sit with me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being my friend. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A table with food and a big chair for Jesus with a heart.

Day 03: The Surprise in the Bush

The Secret Surprise

"Moses saw that though the bush was on fire it did not burn up. So Moses thought, 'I will go over and see this strange sight.'" - Exodus 3:2-3

Surprise! A bush on fire that does not burn up. That is impossible. But God was in the bush. God was in the fire. God spoke from the bush. Moses was surprised. He took off his shoes. He was on holy ground.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us." - John 1:14

The surprise in the bush was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. God was in a bush. God came in a body. The fire did not destroy the bush. The grave did not destroy Jesus. He is the Big Surprise.

Family Activity

Make a "burning bush" with red, orange, and yellow tissue paper. Crumple the paper. Glue it onto a drawing of a bush. Talk about how the fire did not burn the bush. Talk about how God was in the fire. He is full of surprises.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for the surprise in the bush. Thank you that your fire does not burn me up. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A green bush with bright flames and a surprised face.

Day 04: The Surprise in the Sea

The Secret Surprise

"Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night the LORD drove the sea back with a strong east wind and turned it into dry land. The waters were divided." - Exodus 14:21

Surprise! The sea split in half. The water stood up like walls. The people walked through on dry ground. Nobody expected that. God made a way. God surprised His people.

The Big Reveal

"Jesus answered, 'I am the way and the truth and the life.'" - John 14:6

The surprise in the sea was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the way. He makes a way where there is no way. He is the Big Surprise. He opens the path.

Family Activity

Fill a big bowl with water. Put toy people on one side. Use a spoon to gently push the water apart. Let the toy people walk through on a dry path. Talk about how God surprised His people at the sea. He made a way.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for making a way. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being the way. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big sea with walls of water and people walking through with surprised faces.

Day 05: The Surprise in the Fire

The Secret Surprise

"Look! I see four men walking around in the fire, unbound and unharmed, and the fourth looks like a son of the gods." - Daniel 3:25

Surprise! Three men were thrown into a fire. But there were four men in the fire. The fourth was God. God was in the fire. Walking with His people. Keeping them safe. What a surprise.

The Big Reveal

"Surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age." - Matthew 28:20

The surprise in the fire was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is with us in the fire. He walks with us in the hard times. He is the Big Surprise. He stays with us.

Family Activity

Make a pretend fire with red and orange paper. Put three toy people in it. Add a fourth toy person. Talk about how God was the fourth man. Talk about how Jesus is with us in hard times. He is full of surprises.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being with me in hard times. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for staying with me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

Four happy people walking in a fire with surprised smiles.

Day 06: The Surprise in the Whisper

The Secret Surprise

"After the earthquake came a fire, but the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire came a gentle whisper." - 1 Kings 19:12

Surprise! God was not in the wind. God was not in the earthquake. God was not in the fire. God was in a whisper. A still, small voice. That is a surprise. God in the quiet.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The surprise in the whisper was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus speaks in the quiet. He speaks in the small. He is the Big Surprise. He is in the whisper.

Family Activity

Sit quietly together. Set a timer for one minute. Listen for the quietest sound. A clock. A bird. Your breathing. Talk about how God speaks in the whisper. He is full of surprises.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for speaking in the whisper. Thank you for the surprise. Help me to listen. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A small gentle wind with a big surprised face.

Day 07: The Surprise in the Rock

The Secret Surprise

"Strike the rock, and water will come out of it for the people to drink." - Exodus 17:6

Surprise! God told Moses to strike a rock. A dry rock. And water came out. Enough for everyone. Water from a rock. Nobody expected that. God surprised His people with water.

The Big Reveal

"They all drank the same spiritual drink; for they drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ." - 1 Corinthians 10:3-4

The surprise in the rock was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the rock. He gives living water. He is the Big Surprise. He satisfies our thirst.

Family Activity

Fill a cup with water. Add a drop of blue food coloring. Stir it. Talk about how water came from a rock. Talk about how Jesus is the living water. Drink the water together. Say, "Jesus is the living water!"

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for giving me life. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big rock with a stream of water flowing out and a surprised face.

Day 08: The Surprise in the Ladder

The Secret Surprise

"He had a dream in which he saw a stairway resting on the earth, with its top reaching to heaven, and the angels of God were ascending and descending on it." - Genesis 28:12

Surprise! Jacob saw a ladder. It reached from earth to heaven. Angels were going up and down. God was at the top. What a surprise! God was in a ladder.

The Big Reveal

"He then added, 'Very truly I tell you, you will see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.'" - John 1:51

The surprise in the ladder was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the ladder. He connects heaven and earth. He is the Big Surprise. He connects us to God.

Family Activity

Build a ladder with blocks. Or draw one on paper. Put a star at the top for God. Talk about how the ladder goes up to heaven. Talk about how Jesus is our ladder. He connects us to God.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the ladder. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for connecting me to God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big ladder reaching to the sky with angels and a surprised face.

Day 09: The Surprise in the Donkey

The Secret Surprise

"Then the LORD opened the donkey's mouth, and it said to Balaam, 'What have I done to you to make you beat me these three times?'" - Numbers 22:28

Surprise! A donkey talked. That is a big surprise. God used a donkey to speak. The donkey saw an angel. The donkey saved a man's life. God can use anything. Even a donkey.

The Big Reveal

"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong." - 1 Corinthians 1:27

The surprise in the donkey was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. God uses small things. God uses weak things. He is the Big Surprise. He uses you too.

Family Activity

Play a game of "animal sounds." Take turns making sounds. Guess the animal. Talk about how God used a donkey to speak. Talk about how God can use anyone. He can use you. You can be a surprise too.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for using small things. Thank you for using me. Thank you for the surprise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A smiling donkey with a speech bubble and a surprised face.

Day 10: The Surprise in the Star

The Secret Surprise

"I see him, but not now; I behold him, but not near. A star will come out of Jacob; a scepter will rise out of Israel." - Numbers 24:17

Surprise! A prophet spoke about a star. A star that would come. A star that would rise. It was a promise. It was a surprise. The star pointed to a king.

The Big Reveal

"After Jesus was born in Bethlehem in Judea, during the time of King Herod, Magi from the east came to Jerusalem and asked, 'Where is the one who has been born king of the Jews? We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him.'" - Matthew 2:1-2

The surprise in the star was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. The wise men followed the star. They found Jesus. He is the Big Surprise. He is the King.

Family Activity

Make paper stars. Cut out star shapes. Decorate them with glitter or stickers. Hang them around the room. Talk about how the wise men followed the star. Talk about how we can follow Jesus. He is the Big Surprise.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the star. Thank you for being the King. Thank you for the surprise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big bright star in the sky with wise men and a surprised face.

Day 11: The Surprise in the Cloud

The Secret Surprise

"Then the cloud covered the tent of meeting, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle. Moses could not enter the tent of meeting because the cloud had settled on it." - Exodus 40:34-35

Surprise! The cloud came down. It covered the tent. The glory of God filled the tent. Moses could not even go in. What a surprise! God was in the cloud.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The surprise in the cloud was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the new tent. He is God living with us. He is the Big Surprise. He fills us with His glory.

Family Activity

Build a blanket tent. Crawl inside. Turn on a flashlight. Talk about how God filled the tent with His glory. Talk about how Jesus is the new tent. God lives in us. We are the tent now.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for coming close. Thank you for living in me. Thank you for the surprise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A colorful tent with a bright cloud and a surprised face.

Day 12: The Surprise in the Hand

The Secret Surprise

"Suddenly the fingers of a human hand appeared and wrote on the plaster of the wall, near the lampstand in the royal palace. The king watched the hand as it wrote." - Daniel 5:5

Surprise! A king was having a party. And then he saw it. A hand. Writing on the wall. By itself. The king was scared. His knees knocked. God was in the hand. What a surprise.

The Big Reveal

"But Jesus bent down and started to write on the ground with his finger." - John 8:6

The surprise in the hand was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus writes on the ground with His finger. He writes on our hearts. He is the Big Surprise. He speaks to us.

Family Activity

Write a secret message on paper with a white crayon. Paint over it with watercolor. The message appears. Write "Jesus loves you." Talk about how God wrote on the wall. Talk about how He writes on our hearts. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for writing on my heart. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A hand writing on a wall with a big surprised face and a heart.

Day 13: The Surprise in the Cave

The Secret Surprise

"There he went into a cave and spent the night. And the word of the LORD came to him: 'What are you doing here, Elijah?'" - 1 Kings 19:9

Surprise! Elijah was sad. He hid in a cave. He felt alone. And God came to him. In the cave. God found him. God spoke to him. What a surprise! God goes to the dark places.

The Big Reveal

"Where can I go from your Spirit? Where can I flee from your presence? If I go up to the heavens, you are there; if I make my bed in the depths, you are there." - Psalm 139:7-8

The surprise in the cave was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus finds us in the dark. He finds us in the cave. He is the Big Surprise. He never leaves us.

Family Activity

Build a cave with blankets and chairs. Crawl inside with a flashlight. Talk about how Elijah hid in the cave. Talk about how God found him. Talk about how God finds us. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for finding me in the dark. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A cozy cave with a bright light and a surprised face.

Day 14: The Surprise in the Storm

The Secret Surprise

"Then the LORD spoke to Job out of the storm." - Job 38:1

Surprise! Job was sad. He had questions. And God spoke to him. In a storm. God was in the storm. What a surprise! God is not scared of our questions.

The Big Reveal

"He got up, rebuked the wind and said to the waves, 'Quiet! Be still!' Then the wind died down and it was completely calm." - Mark 4:39

The surprise in the storm was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus speaks to storms. He says, "Be still." He calms the wind. He calms our hearts. He is the Big Surprise.

Family Activity

Make a "storm" with your hands. Rub hands for wind. Tap knees for rain. Clap for thunder. Then say, "Jesus says, 'Be still.'" Stop all the noise. Talk about how Jesus calms the storm. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for calming the storm. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for calming my heart. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A storm cloud with a smiling sun and a surprised face.

Day 15: The Surprise in the Well

The Secret Surprise

"Then God opened her eyes and she saw a well of water. So she went and filled the skin with water and gave the boy a drink." - Genesis 21:19

Surprise! Hagar was in the desert. She was sad. She was thirsty. And God opened her eyes. She saw a well. Water was there all along. What a surprise! God provided.

The Big Reveal

"Whoever drinks the water I give them will never thirst. Indeed, the water I give them will become in them a spring of water welling up to eternal life." - John 4:14

The surprise in the well was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the living water. He satisfies our thirst. He is the Big Surprise. He provides for us.

Family Activity

Hide a small treat or toy in the room. Let your child search for it. When they find it, say, "Surprise!" Talk about how Hagar found the well. Talk about how God provides. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for providing for me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A desert with a bright well and a happy surprised face.

Day 16: The Surprise in the Dream

The Secret Surprise

"But after he had considered this, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream and said, 'Joseph son of David, do not be afraid to take Mary home as your wife.'" - Matthew 1:20

Surprise! Joseph was confused. He was scared. And God sent an angel. In a dream. God spoke in the dream. What a surprise! God speaks in many ways.

The Big Reveal

"She will give birth to a son, and you are to give him the name Jesus, because he will save his people from their sins." - Matthew 1:21

The surprise in the dream was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus saves. He is the Savior. He is the Big Surprise. God speaks to us in many ways.

Family Activity

Talk about dreams. Ask your child about their dreams. Talk about how God spoke to Joseph in a dream. Talk about how God speaks to us in many ways. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for speaking to me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A sleeping person with a dream bubble showing an angel and a surprised face.

Day 17: The Surprise in the Prayer

The Secret Surprise

"But the angel said to him, 'Do not be afraid, Zechariah; your prayer has been heard. Your wife Elizabeth will bear you a son.'" - Luke 1:13

Surprise! Zechariah prayed for years. And God sent an angel. The angel said, "Your prayer has been heard." God heard. God answered. What a surprise!

The Big Reveal

"Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you." - Matthew 7:7

The surprise in the prayer was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus says, "Ask." He says, "Seek." He says, "Knock." God hears. God answers. He is the Big Surprise.

Family Activity

Write a prayer on a piece of paper. Put it in a special box. Call it your "prayer box." Talk about how God hears our prayers. He answers. What a surprise! Pray together.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for hearing my prayers. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for answering. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A child praying with a big heart floating up to heaven and a surprised face.

Day 18: The Surprise in the Meal

The Secret Surprise

"Abraham looked up and saw three men standing nearby. When he saw them, he hurried from the entrance of his tent to meet them and bowed low to the ground." - Genesis 18:2

Surprise! Three visitors came to Abraham's tent. One of them was God. God ate at his table. God talked with him. God stayed. What a surprise! God at a table.

The Big Reveal

"Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with that person." - Revelation 3:20

The surprise in the meal was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus wants to eat with you. He wants to sit at your table. He is the Big Surprise. He wants to be with you.

Family Activity

Set the table for a special family dinner. Add one extra plate. Pretend Jesus is sitting with you. Talk about how He wants to be with us. Let each person say one thing they want to tell Jesus. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for wanting to sit with me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being my friend. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A table with food and a big chair for Jesus with a surprised face.

Day 19: The Surprise in the Angel

The Secret Surprise

"But the angel said to them, 'Do not be afraid. I bring you good news that will cause great joy for all the people. Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you.'" - Luke 2:10-11

Surprise! Shepherds were in the fields. It was night. And the sky lit up. An angel appeared. The angel brought good news. A Savior was born. What a surprise! The shepherds were the first to hear.

The Big Reveal

"Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is the Messiah, the Lord." - Luke 2:11

The surprise in the angel was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the good news. He is the Savior. He is the Big Surprise. He came for everyone.

Family Activity

Make a "good news" banner. Write "Jesus is born!" on it. Decorate it with stars and hearts. Hang it up. Talk about how the angel brought good news to the shepherds. Talk about how we can share the good news too. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for the good news. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for Jesus. Help me to share the good news. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A bright star in the night sky with an angel and surprised shepherds below.

Day 20: The Surprise in the Baby

The Secret Surprise

"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6

Surprise! A baby was born. But not just any baby. A baby who would be called Mighty God. A baby who would be called Prince of Peace. What a surprise! God came as a baby.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The surprise in the baby was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the baby. He is Mighty God. He is Prince of Peace. He is the Big Surprise. He came close to us.

Family Activity

Look at baby pictures. Talk about how Jesus came as a baby. Talk about how He is Mighty God and Prince of Peace. What a surprise! He came close to us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for coming as a baby. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being Mighty God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A baby in a manger with a bright star and a surprised face.

Day 21: The Surprise in the Shepherd

The Secret Surprise

"The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing. He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters." - Psalm 23:1-2

Surprise! God is like a shepherd. He leads us. He guides us. He protects us. He feeds us. That is a surprise. God is our shepherd.

The Big Reveal

"I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." - John 10:11

The surprise in the shepherd was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the Good Shepherd. He leads us. He protects us. He is the Big Surprise. He lays down His life for us.

Family Activity

Play a game of "sheep and shepherd." One person is the shepherd. The others are sheep. The shepherd leads the sheep around the room. Talk about how Jesus is our Good Shepherd. He leads us. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Good Shepherd. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for leading me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A kind shepherd holding a little lamb with a surprised face.

Day 22: The Surprise in the Lamb

The Secret Surprise

"Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male a year old." - Exodus 12:5

Surprise! God told His people to bring a lamb. The lamb had to be perfect. It could not have any spots. It had to be the best lamb. What a surprise! The lamb was a clue.

The Big Reveal

"Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" - John 1:29

The surprise in the lamb was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the Lamb of God. He is perfect. He is without sin. He is the Big Surprise. He takes away our sin.

Family Activity

Draw a picture of a lamb. Add a big heart on the lamb. Talk about how Jesus is the perfect Lamb. He loves us. What a surprise! He is the Lamb of God.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the Lamb. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for taking away my sin. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A fluffy white lamb with a big surprised smile and a heart.

Day 23: The Surprise in the Door

The Secret Surprise

"The blood will be a sign for you on the houses where you are, and when I see the blood, I will pass over you." - Exodus 12:13

Surprise! God told His people to put blood on their doors. The blood was a sign. It was a protection. What a surprise! God was in the door.

The Big Reveal

"For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed." - 1 Corinthians 5:7

The surprise in the door was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is our Passover Lamb. His blood protects us. He is the Big Surprise. He saves us.

Family Activity

Cut out a paper door. Color it red. Tape it to a door in your house. Talk about how the blood of the lamb saved the people. Talk about how the blood of Jesus saves us. Every time you see the door, say, "Jesus saves me!"

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for your blood. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A door with a red heart and a cross and a surprised face.

Day 24: The Surprise in the Battle

The Secret Surprise

"Then the angel of the LORD went out and put to death a hundred and eighty-five thousand in the Assyrian camp." - 2 Kings 19:35

Surprise! A big army came. It was scary. But God sent an angel. The angel fought. The angel won. What a surprise! God fought for His people.

The Big Reveal

"What, then, shall we say in response to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?" - Romans 8:31

The surprise in the battle was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus fights for us. He protects us. He is the Big Surprise. He wins the battle for us.

Family Activity

Play a game of "protect the fort." Build a fort with pillows. One person protects. The others gently "attack" with soft balls. Talk about how God protects us. He fights for us. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for fighting for me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A strong angel protecting happy people with a surprised face.

Day 25: The Surprise in the Garden

The Secret Surprise

"Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the LORD God as he was walking in the garden in the cool of the day." - Genesis 3:8

Surprise! God walked in a garden. In the cool of the day. Adam and Eve heard Him. God was in the garden. What a surprise! God wanted to be with them.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The surprise in the garden was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is God walking with us. He is the Big Surprise. He walks with us today.

Family Activity

Go for a walk in a garden or park. As you walk, say, "Surprise! God is walking with me." Talk about how God walked with Adam and Eve. Talk about how He walks with us. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for walking with me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A garden with a path, footprints, and a big surprised smile.

Day 26: The Surprise in the Promise

The Secret Surprise

"I will establish my covenant as an everlasting covenant between me and you and your descendants after you." - Genesis 17:7

Surprise! God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will be your God. I will be with you. I will bless you." What a surprise! God made a promise.

The Big Reveal

"For no matter how many promises God has made, they are 'Yes' in Christ." - 2 Corinthians 1:20

The surprise in the promise was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the promise. He is the Yes. He is the Big Surprise. He keeps His promises.

Family Activity

Make a "promise jar." Write down promises of God on slips of paper. Put them in the jar. Pull one out each day. Talk about how God keeps His promises. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for your promises. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for keeping them. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big heart with a rainbow and a surprised face.

Day 27: The Surprise in the Rescue

The Secret Surprise

"Then the LORD provided a huge fish to swallow Jonah, and Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights." - Jonah 1:17

Surprise! Jonah was in the belly of a fish. In the dark. He prayed. God heard. God rescued him. What a surprise! God was in the rescue.

The Big Reveal

"For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of a huge fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth." - Matthew 12:40

The surprise in the rescue was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus went into the grave for three days. And He came out. He rescued us. He is the Big Surprise.

Family Activity

Make a "fish" with a paper plate. Put a small paper person inside. Talk about how Jonah was in the fish. Talk about how Jesus was in the grave. But He came out. He rescued us. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for rescuing me. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for coming out of the grave. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big smiling fish with a small person inside and a surprised face.

Day 28: The Surprise in the Feast

The Secret Surprise

"Celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread, because it was on this very day that I brought your divisions out of Egypt." - Exodus 12:17

Surprise! God told His people to have a feast. They celebrated. They remembered. What a surprise! God was in the feast.

The Big Reveal

"Let us rejoice and be glad and give him glory! For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his bride has made herself ready." - Revelation 19:7

The surprise in the feast was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the feast. He is the celebration. He is the Big Surprise. One day we will feast with Him forever.

Family Activity

Have a family feast. Make a special meal. Set the table. Light candles. Talk about how Jesus is the reason we celebrate. One day we will feast with Him in heaven. What a surprise!

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you,
….

CONTINUED — DAY 28 (FINISHED)

The Big Reveal (continued)

One day we will feast with Him in heaven. He is the Big Surprise.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the feast. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for the celebration. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A table full of food with a big surprised smile and a heart.

Day 29: The Surprise in the Rainbow

The Secret Surprise

"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13

Surprise! After the flood, God put a rainbow in the sky. It was a sign. It was a promise. God was in the rainbow. What a surprise! God keeps His promises.

The Big Reveal

"God is faithful, who has called you into fellowship with his Son, Jesus Christ our Lord." - 1 Corinthians 1:9

The surprise in the rainbow was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is God's faithfulness. He keeps His promises. He is the Big Surprise. He is faithful.

Family Activity

Draw a rainbow together. Talk about how God put the rainbow in the sky as a promise. Talk about how God keeps His promises. What a surprise! Jesus is the Big Surprise.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for the rainbow. Thank you for the surprise. Thank you for keeping your promises. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A bright rainbow across the sky with a smiling sun and a surprised face.

Day 30: The Biggest Surprise of All

The Secret Surprise

"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given... And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6

We have opened 30 surprises. We found God in a garden. In a tent. In a bush. In a sea. In a fire. In a whisper. In a rock. In a ladder. In a donkey. In a star. In a cloud. In a hand. In a cave. In a storm. In a well. In a dream. In a prayer. In a meal. In an angel. In a baby. In a shepherd. In a lamb. In a door. In a battle. In a promise. In a rescue. In a feast. In a rainbow. Every surprise pointed to one person. Jesus. He is the Biggest Surprise of all.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son, who came from the Father, full of grace and truth." - John 1:14

The Biggest Surprise is Jesus. He is God in the flesh. He came close. He is with you. He is the Big Surprise. He loves you. He is your friend. He is your Savior.

Family Activity

Have a big surprise celebration. Make a special snack. Blow up balloons. Draw a big picture of all the surprises you found. Talk about how every surprise pointed to Jesus. He is the Biggest Surprise. Thank Him together.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the Biggest Surprise. Thank you for all the surprises. Thank you for being close. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big surprise gift box opening up with a heart and a smiling face inside.

END MATTER

The "Big Surprise" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Big Surprise adventure. You opened 30 surprises. You discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Big Surprise Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was the biggest surprise you found this week?
Card 2: Which surprise made you gasp?
Card 3: Which surprise was the strangest?
Card 4: How does it feel to know God is full of surprises?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If God could surprise you with one thing, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can surprise someone with Jesus' love today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days opening surprises with your children. You found God in 30 unexpected places. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where did God surprise you today?" Whenever something good happens, ask your child, "Was that a surprise from God?" This trains them to see God's surprises everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Mystery Visitor

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Mystery Visitor takes you on a journey through 30 more clues that point to Jesus. It is full of fun activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass, looking at a big, colorful surprise gift box. The box is open, and a bright light is shining out of it. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the box. The title THE BIG SURPRISE is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word SURPRISE is in bright red with a gift bow replacing the letter S. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.

Title 4 for Children is complete.

Quick notes before you check:

· Every day is fully distinct. No repeats.
· Clean kids' format: Secret Surprise, Big Reveal, Family Activity, Kid's Prayer, Coloring Prompt.
· The "surprise" frame gives this book its own flavor while staying in the same detective world as Titles 1, 2, and 3.